



WEBINAR

AI and API

How connectivity evolves — from enterprise integration to autonomous agents — and why the gateway still decides what gets through.

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AGENDA

What we'll cover

01

Introduction to AI and API

The two words, defined — and why they're suddenly in the same sentence.

02

APIs and enterprise integration

How the enterprise is wired, and why a control point exists.

03

The role of APIs in AI

A model that can't call an API can only talk.

04

How AI changes integration

MCP, code mode, and agents reshape the traffic.

05

What holds: APIs + governance

The API didn't leave. The need to govern it grew.



LIVE DEMO

API → gateway → AI → MCP →
governance

APIs and AI, defined



API

A contract for how software talks to software.

Send a request, get a response. Stable, versioned, predictable. It's how one system uses another without knowing its insides.



AI (here: LLMs + agents)

Systems that reason over language and decide what to do.

Powerful at planning. Useless at acting — until you give them something to call. On their own, they only produce text.

One is how systems connect. The other is what now sits on top, asking to connect to everything.

APIs wire the enterprise

Every system exposes an API. The gateway is the one place you route, secure, and watch the traffic between them.

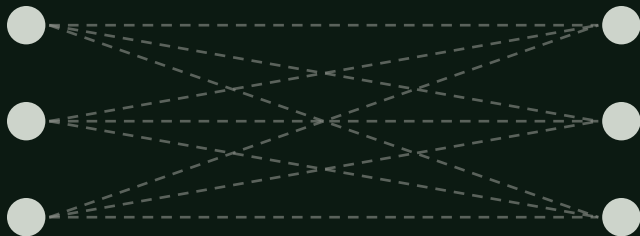
Without a control point:

point-to-point sprawl — every team rebuilding auth, retries, and logging by hand.



The control point wins

POINT-TO-POINT



$N \times M$ connectors to build and maintain

THROUGH A GATEWAY



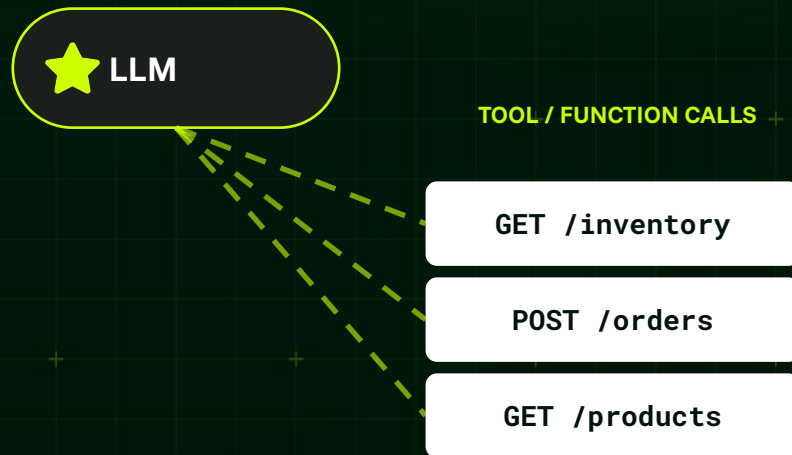
$N + M$ — one place to secure and observe

Models talk. APIs act.

Function calling, retrieval, actions — every time an LLM does something real, it's calling an API underneath.

The model is the brain. The API is the hands.

No tools, no action — just a very fluent description of what it would do.





04 / THE SHIFT

One protocol, not N×M

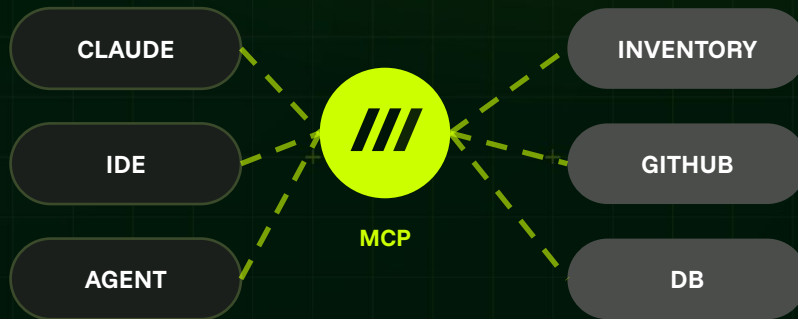
Model Context Protocol — open standard from Anthropic (Nov 2024), now under the Linux Foundation. A client/server protocol over JSON-RPC. **The USB-C port for AI tools.**

97M+

monthly SDK downloads

1,000s

public MCP servers



any client · any server

Code mode + agents

CODE MODE MCP

Instead of many tool calls, the model writes code that calls the tools once.

Models are better at writing code than at chaining calls by hand.

~14× fewer input tokens · 40–50% lower latency

AGENTS & A2A

Agents call tools (MCP) and call each other (agent-to-agent).

The unit of work becomes a reasoning loop, not a single request.

More autonomy · more calls · **less human in the loop**

The traffic stops being human-paced. It becomes machine-paced.

The head comes off

Integration didn't only change behind the scenes. The front end — the UI itself — has been detaching from the backend for years. AI removes the last attachment.



01

Monolith

The UI is fused to the backend. To do the work, a human logs into the app and clicks through its screens.



02

Headless

The presentation layer is decoupled. The backend is just APIs; the web app is one client among many.



03

Agentic

No fixed head at all. Every capability is an API, MCP tool, or CLI command. Agents drive the platform directly.



PROOF POINT Salesforce Headless 360 (Apr 2026) now exposes its whole platform as APIs, MCP tools, and CLI commands — so agents, and people through them, drive it without opening the app. Co-founder Parker Harris put it bluntly: **“Why should you ever log into Salesforce again?”**

The interface renders itself

If the platform is all APIs and tools, the screen is no longer the front door. The experience gets assembled at request time — and an LLM client like Claude can build it on the fly.



Conversation as interface

The app stops being a place you go. Work happens in-channel.



Multi-modal, not one dashboard

Text, voice, an approval card, a chart — whatever fits the moment.



Generated on demand

The client builds the view for the task, then discards it.



Personalized per request

Same data, a different surface per user and per intent.

When the surface is generated, you can't govern the screen. You govern the call underneath — the same control point, now the only stable thing in the stack.

05 / WHAT HOLDS

The API didn't go away. It went under the agent.

Every MCP tool and every agent action still resolves to an API call. The substrate is unchanged — what changed is who's calling, how often, and how predictably.

NEW SURFACE, OLD DISCIPLINE — THE RISKS THAT SHOW UP IN PRODUCTION



Tool poisoning

Malicious tool descriptions steer the model.



Tool shadowing

A rogue server intercepts trusted calls.



Server sprawl

Dozens of MCP servers, no inventory.



Runaway cost

Loops burn tokens with no ceiling.



No audit trail

Who did what, on whose behalf?

Same blueprint, new parts

You've seen this shape before. Every layer of SOA's reference architecture now has an AI-era counterpart — and the systems of record underneath don't move.

CLASSIC SOA · 2000s

Presentation layer

Process orchestration (BPEL)

Enterprise service bus (ESB)

Services + registry (WSDL / UDDI)

AI-ERA · 2020s

Generated, multimodal UI

Agent orchestration + A2A

AI + agent gateway

APIs as MCP tools + registry

CROSS-CUTTING, THEN AND NOW Security, QoS, and monitoring were the vertical pillars of SOA. In the AI era they become agent authentication, rate limits, cost control, observability, and policy — the same job, harder.

The same job, harder



Authn / Authz

Who is calling, on whose behalf



Rate limits & quotas

Ceilings on machine-paced loops



Observability & audit

Every call traced and logged



Cost control

Token budgets, showback, chargeback



Policy enforcement

What's allowed, redacted, blocked



Discovery & catalog

One inventory of tools and servers

One control plane for **LLM, MCP, and agent-to-agent (A2A) traffic** — Kong AI Gateway, MCP Gateway, and Agent Gateway.

Five stages, one backend

01 A plain API

Run the Inventory & Orders service. curl it directly.

02 API behind a gateway

Put Kong in front. Routing becomes a control point.

03 AI calls the API

An LLM uses function calling to check stock and order.

04 The API as an MCP server

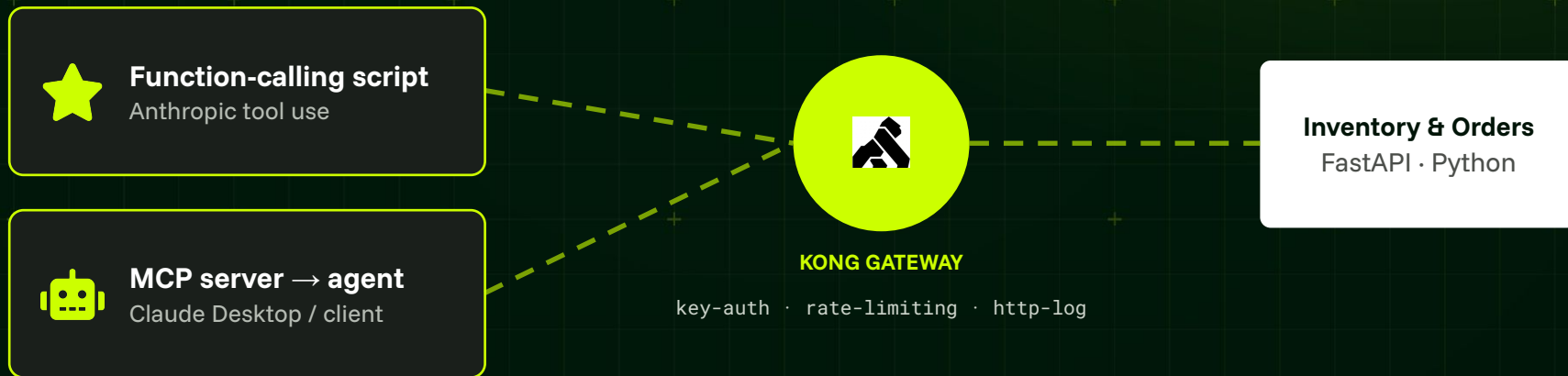
An agent discovers the tools. Then code mode.

05 Governance on

Key-auth, rate limits, request logging — enforced.



LIVE DEMO



Stack: Docker · Python 3.11+ · Kong Gateway (OSS, DB-less) · MCP Python SDK · Claude Desktop

Extend the gateway to MCP

You don't stand up a new stack for MCP. The gateway you already run becomes an MCP gateway with a small set of plugins.

WHAT PRODUCTION NEEDS

Expose an API as MCP

Authenticate callers

Scope tool-level access

Cap rate and cost

Trace and audit every call



MINIMAL KONG SET

AI MCP Proxy

AI MCP OAuth2

ACL

Rate Limiting

AI audit logs & metrics

BEYOND THE FIVE Catalog approved servers in Konnect (MCP Registry) to curb sprawl. The MCP-native plugins ship with Kong AI Gateway; the same control plane governs LLM, MCP, and agent traffic.

Token exchange at the edge

When an agent calls through the gateway, which token reaches the backend? Forward a broad one and it's over-privileged and blind to who really called.

THE RISK

Over-privileged calls

Lost user identity

Token replay

Foreign / opaque tokens

Oversharing claims

WHAT TOKEN EXCHANGE GIVES

Downscope to least privilege

On-behalf-of delegation

Audience-bound tokens

Translate to an internal JWT

Strip PII at the edge

WHY THE GATEWAY It sees every token and talks to every service — the one place to swap a broad credential for a right-sized one. RFC 8693, in Kong's OpenID Connect plugin.

TAKEAWAYS

Four things to leave with

01 **AI doesn't replace APIs.**

It consumes them faster, and far less predictably.

02 **MCP standardizes the connection.**

It does not standardize the control. That's still on you.

03 **Code mode and agents change the traffic.**

From human-paced clicks to machine-paced loops.

04 **Governance is what ships agentic AI.**

Auth, limits, observability, policy — the same job, harder.



Build the connectivity layer of AI.

The gateway never stopped being the answer. The traffic just got smarter.

RESOURCES

Kong AI Gateway · MCP Gateway · Agent Gateway developer.konghq.com

Demo repo: ready to rebuild. **Thanks — questions?**